

scrolling remains smooth, and general multitasking does not introduce noticeable stutter or lag. For typical usage, the experience is stable and predictable.

Gaming performance highlights the chipset limitations. During extended sessions of BGMI, frame drops were noticeable. Thermal behaviour remains controlled, but sustained performance does not improve over the previous generation. This reinforces the positioning of the Realme 16 Pro as a general-use device rather than one aimed at performance-focused users, which feels harder to justify at this price point.

Benchmark results reflect this behaviour. Realme claims an Antutu score of around 971,000, and the review

In daylight conditions, the main camera performs well. Images are sharp and detailed, with colours that remain close to natural. Highlights and shadows are handled competently, and dynamic range is solid across most scenes. The camera also slightly brightens human subjects, but facial detail is retained rather than aggressively smoothed.

Digital zoom performance is better than expected. At 2x, images remain clean and detailed. Even at 4x, results remain usable, which is not always the case in this segment.

Portrait mode is another strong area. Background separation appears natural, and edge detection is generally reliable. The phone allows portrait shooting at

processing, making it one of the more reliable selfie cameras in this category.

VERDICT

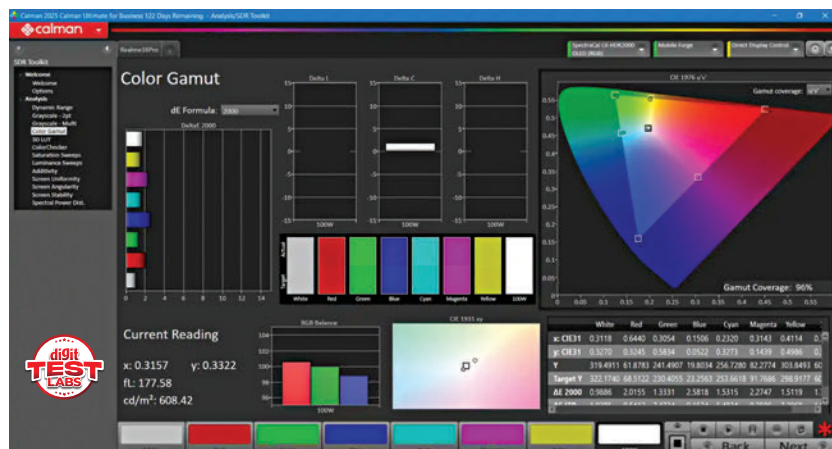
The Realme 16 Pro is, by most measures, a good mid-range phone. It delivers strong battery life, a capable 200-megapixel main camera, and a smooth, bright display that performs well in everyday use. As a daily driver, it is reliable and easy to live with.

However, it is difficult to ignore the pricing. At Rs 31,999, the decision to move from a Snapdragon 7 Gen 4 to the Dimensity 7300 chip feels like a compromise driven by rising component costs rather than user benefit. This effectively makes the current performance level the new default for Realme at this price, while the Realme 16 Pro Plus retains the Snapdragon chip at a significantly higher cost.

For users upgrading from the Realme 15 Pro, the 16 Pro only makes sense if camera improvements and battery life are your absolute top priorities. Otherwise, the overall experience remains largely familiar, with no clear performance advantage.

For new buyers, the Realme 16 Pro is a sensible phone, but not an aggressively priced one. It is good at what it does, yet its value proposition is weakened by the chipset choice at this price point.

—Siddharth Malhotra



unit scored close to one million. In the CPU throttling test, performance stabilised at 95%. Geekbench scores measured 990 for single-core and 2,875 for multi-core performance. The phone scored 2,177 in the 3DMark Wild Life. These numbers are consistent with expectations, but they also show the lack of a major performance upgrade.

CAMERA

Cameras are clearly the central focus of the Realme 16 Pro. The phone features a 200MP main sensor, paired with an 8MP ultra-wide sensor. This is the most visible upgrade over the Realme 15 Pro 5G and is where Realme is clearly attempting to justify the pricing.

five different focal lengths, though most testing was done at 2x. In some situations, facial softness is visible, particularly under uneven lighting.

The ultra-wide camera maintains consistent colour tuning with the main sensor, but details are lower. Images tend to look soft, and on occasion, photos exhibited a visible green tint.

Video recording is supported up to 4K at 30 frames per second. The output is usable but rather unremarkable. Stabilisation is adequate for casual use, but this is not a phone aimed at video-focused creators.

On the front, the 50MP selfie camera delivers strong results. Selfies are sharp, with good detail and controlled

SPECIFICATIONS

SoC: MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Max 5G Chipset | GPU: Arm Mali-G615 GPU | RAM: 8/12 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128/256 GB UFS 2.1 | Display: 6.78-inch 1.5K AMOLED panel | Refresh Rate: 144 Hz | OS: Realme UI 7.0 | Camera (Rear): 200MP + 8MP Ultrawide | Camera (Front): 50MP | Battery: 7000 mAh | Charging: 80 W

CONTACT

Company: Realme India | Phone: 1800 102 2777 | Email: Web Form | Website: <https://www.realme.com/in/support>

